

Teaching Assistant – Primary

Teaching Assistants at Leigh Academies Trust are integral to nurturing the educational journey and holistic development of every student in their early years. They cultivate a supportive and dynamic learning environment, working in close partnership with class teachers and specialist staff to enhance curriculum delivery across the academy. Teaching Assistants empower pupils to become confident and engaged learners, offering tailored support to help all students, including those with special educational needs, flourish within the primary setting.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the Teaching Assistant is to champion the education, wellbeing, and success of pupils by facilitating high-quality teaching and learning for school-aged children in the academy. Teaching Assistants contribute to a respectful and inclusive atmosphere where all pupils feel valued, supported, and encouraged to achieve their full potential. They play a crucial role in supporting engaging and well-structured learning activities, adapting resources to meet individual needs, and providing valuable feedback to both students and teachers. By promoting positive behaviour, fostering independence, and collaborating with parents and carers, Teaching Assistants are key in shaping a positive and aspirational learning community within the academy.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Supporting Teaching and Learning

- Plan and prepare for small group interventions, actively participating in all stages of the planning cycle, including planning and evaluation. This may include phonics, early reading, or numeracy interventions.
- Develop and prepare resources for learning activities that align with lesson plans and effectively address the diverse needs of individual primary pupils. This could involve creating age-appropriate visual aids, hands-on materials, or differentiated worksheets.

2. Promoting Inclusion and Independence

- To assist in the implementation of Individual Programmes for pupils, meticulously monitoring their progress and adapting support as needed.
- To reinforce the academy's behaviour policy consistently and positively, aiming to raise pupils' self-esteem and encourage independent working habits, particularly for foundational learning stages.
- To assist the teacher in monitoring pupil progress by maintaining daily observation records and special needs records as required, contributing to a comprehensive understanding of each child's development.

- To foster and maintain constructive and supportive relationships with pupils, showing empathy and understanding of their diverse needs.

3. Collaboration and Communication

- To work collaboratively with other professionals, such as Speech Therapists and Educational Psychologists, as necessary, to provide holistic support for pupils.
- To maintain a positive, supportive attitude within the team, actively implementing agreed school policies, aims, and objectives, and promoting the school ethos.
- To engage with parents/carers under the guidance of the class teacher, sharing appropriate information about student progress and fostering strong home-school partnerships.
- To participate actively in in-service training and attend staff meetings when appropriate, contributing to a culture of continuous improvement.

4. Pastoral Care and Environment

- To undertake playground duty on a rota basis during break times and lunchtimes, ensuring a safe and positive environment for all pupils during unstructured times.
- To contribute to the effective running of the academy by setting an excellent example in terms of dress, punctuality, and attendance.



Person Specification – Teaching Assistant

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the Teaching Assistant role in a primary academy:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Educated to GCSE level standard or equivalent (English and Maths A*–C grade or equivalent).

Desirable:

- Training or expertise in specific intervention strategies (e.g., early years phonics, early reading, numeracy support).

Experience

Essential:

- An interest in working with children, particularly those with diverse needs, and a willingness to learn about supporting them.

Desirable:

- Experience in a similar role or school setting.
- Experience working with children who have special educational needs.
- Experience supporting individuals or small groups of primary pupils.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Basic knowledge of Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND) and other barriers to learning, including ASD, Visual Impairments, Physical Disabilities, and Mental Health.
- Understanding of basic first aid principles.
- Awareness of safeguarding and child protection procedures.

Desirable:

- Understanding of child development and learning processes.
- Knowledge of strategies for promoting positive behaviour in a primary school environment.
- Familiarity with the National Curriculum for primary education.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Ability to work constructively as part of a team.
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills, with the ability to build positive relationships with children and adults.
- A desire to make a difference to the lives of young people.

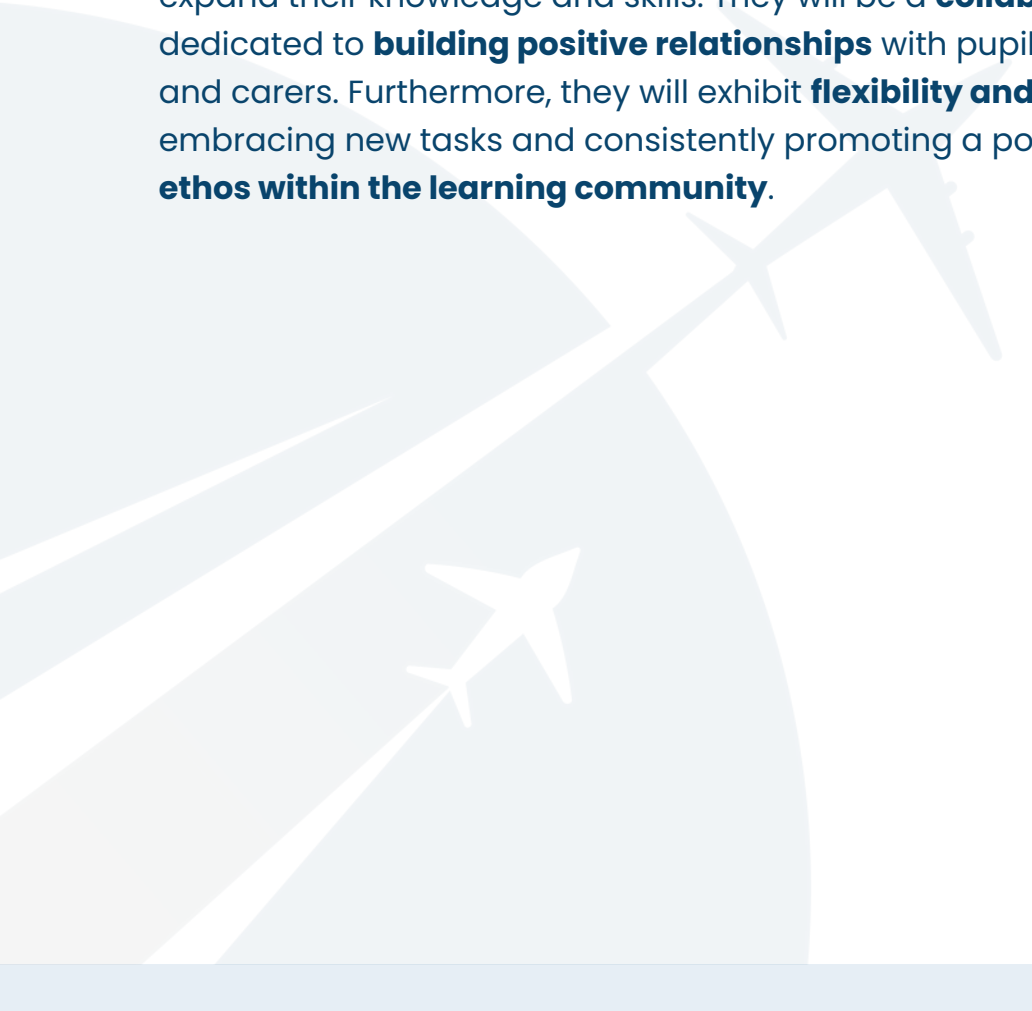
- Ability to work proactively within the ethos of the Academy.
- Good written and oral communication skills.
- Sensitivity and understanding, with active listening skills.
- Patience and the ability to remain calm in stressful situations.
- Basic proficiency in using technology such as computers, video equipment, and photocopiers, with the ability to develop skills further.
- Ability to respond appropriately to the needs of children.

Desirable:

- Ability to adapt teaching methods and materials to meet individual learning styles.
- Strong organisational skills.
- Ability to work independently when required.

Personal Qualities and Attributes

The Teaching Assistant will demonstrate a **proactive and positive approach** to their role, with a strong commitment to fostering a **supportive and inclusive learning environment** for children at this crucial stage of their education. They will be **resilient and resourceful, capable of making sound judgments** and **remaining calm under pressure** while effectively supporting pupils through challenging situations. The Teaching Assistant will value ongoing professional development, **actively engaging in training opportunities** and seeking to expand their knowledge and skills. They will be a **collaborative team player**, dedicated to **building positive relationships** with pupils, colleagues, parents, and carers. Furthermore, they will exhibit **flexibility and adaptability**, readily embracing new tasks and consistently promoting a positive and **aspirational ethos within the learning community**.



Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) ([Department of Education](#)).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.